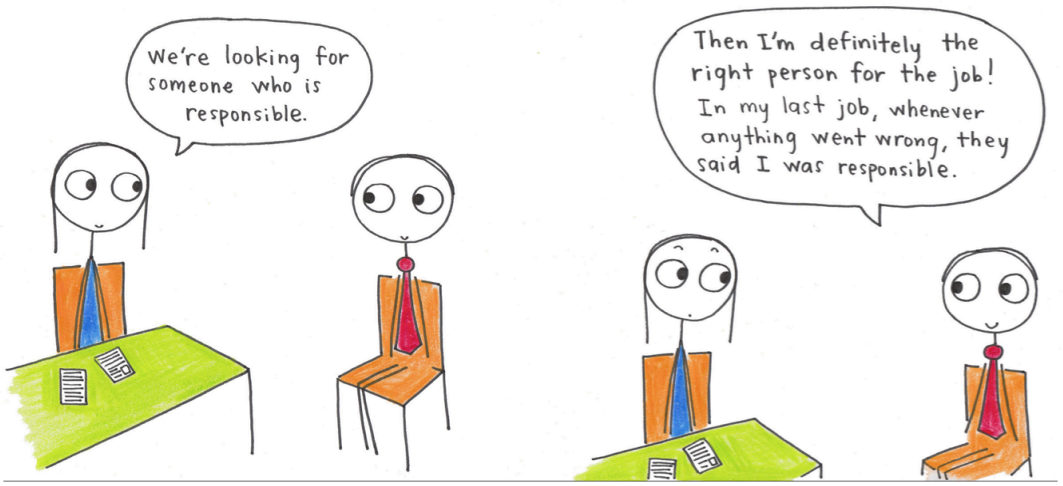
MODULE 2

THE RIGHT PERSON FOR THE RIGHT JOB



Topics	Functions	Structures
Personality traits	• Describing personality • Talking about professions • Defining strengths and weaknesses • Talking and asking about past actions • Illustrating your point	• Be + a/an + adjective + singular noun • Be good/bad + at + -ing • Find it + adjective + "to" infinitive • Like + -ing • Connectors: also, what's more, besides, after, before. • Past Simple vs. Past Perfect • Question structure: Past Perfect
Fiction		
Time for Fiction II: "A Sound of Thunder" by Ray Bradbury - Part II		
Academic literacy		
Abstracts: Background and Purpose		

SECTION 1

BEFORE READING

Read the title of the text and look at the paratext. Then…

a) Underline three possible synonyms of the word *trait* /treɪt/ (n).

peculiarity – intent – mark – attribute – purpose – characteristic

b) Underline two possible synonyms of the word *hired* /haɪəd/ (v).

recruited – invited – fired – accepted – employed – required

c) Tick the idea that you think best illustrates the content of the text.

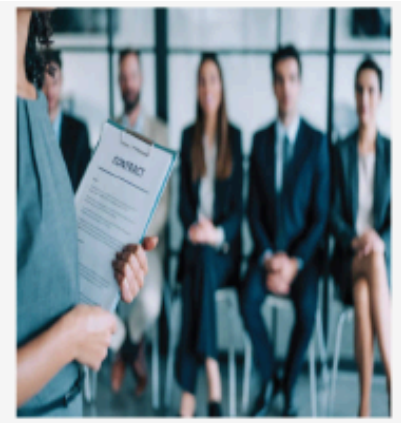
1. The typical roles developed in a multinational company.
2. The most relevant qualities of a competent employee.
3. The necessary steps to prepare for a job interview.

WHILE READING

Now, read the text and check if your answers to the previous activity were right.

The Personality Traits Needed to be Hired

By Katharine Paljug, Business News Daily Contributing Writer, February 9, 2018 10:15 am EST



When you're applying for a job, your professional success and industry experience are only part of what your interviewer wants to see. Many times, your personality traits are crucial for getting the job because they make you the right fit for the company.

"Employers want to know about your hard skills, which show that you are qualified for a position. Also, they want to see that you will fit in with the company culture. The only way to assess this is to get a sense of your personality," said Susan

Peppercorn, CEO of Positive Workplace Partners. "Knowing that someone has the experience and skills to be successful in a job is very important, but when two candidates have similar capabilities, often the soft skills are the reason why one person gets the job and the other doesn't."

A study by the career resource site CareerBuilder found that many employers prioritize the same soft skills in employees, looking for candidates who are dependable, positive, flexible and effective communicators who work well under pressure, among other personality traits.

The right personality traits can make the difference between a strong candidate and a new employee.

1. A multitasker

Companies rarely hire employees to perform only one function. Especially in a small business, companies need people that are willing to come out of their roles and perform different and varied tasks. If you are a multitasker, you will have many chances to be hired.

2. A strategist

Career psychologist Eileen Sharaga said that every business needs a strategic thinker. Therefore, when managers are hired, they want someone who is good at identifying long-term goals. "You should demonstrate that you have not only a vision for the future, but also a plan to get there," she explained. If you can plan strategically, you will be successful.

3. A decider

"People who can use their own judgment and take decisive action are valuable to any company," Selewach said. Business leaders can't be involved in every minor decision, so they should look for a candidate who has the ability to act and take responsibility for the results. If you want to move into a management position which involves leadership, you will have to decide by yourself.

4. A cautious person

Beth Gilfeather, CEO and founder of Sevenstep Recruiting, told the site Career Builder a cautious employee acts prudently as a counterbalance to risk-takers. "They do not like risks as risky situations make them nervous. Therefore, they provide stability and balance. If you want to prevent dangerous risks, you will need to hire an employee with this personality trait," she said.

5. An independent thinker

Some employees think they must agree with what their boss says at all times, without questioning. Although these people may be good at following instructions, leaders ultimately need team members who will challenge the *status quo* if it's better for the business. "I want people who will not be afraid of contradicting my decisions if they think it is better for the company," Meg Sheetz, president of Medifast, told the site.

6. A team player

Most jobs require some kind of collaboration, whether with a team of other employees, a group of clients or occasional outside contractors. The ability to work pleasantly and effectively with others is a key part of nearly any job. If you find it easy to deal with people, you will be considered a good candidate who is flexible enough to get along well with a variety of personalities and work styles.

7. A cultural fit

Employers look for people who can fit in the company's culture. Every company's culture is different and each is founded on different values. "Our culture is founded upon a work-hard, play-hard, humble environment that prioritizes self-reflection and collaboration," said Max Yoder, CEO of an online training software company. If you match these values, you will be the perfect cultural fit.

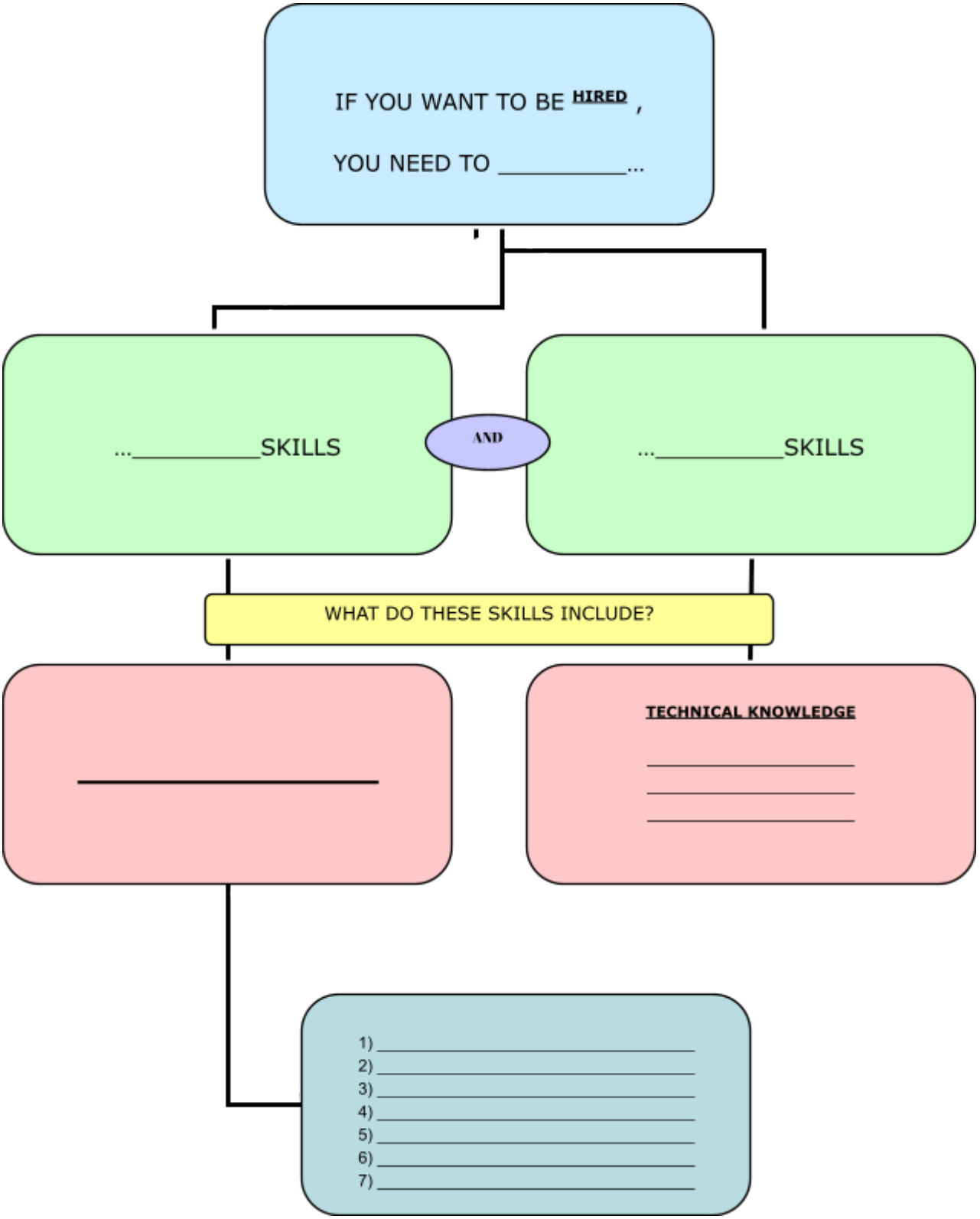
Personality traits are difficult to demonstrate on a resume, so it's essential to highlight them during the interview. However, simply stating you're a team player, for instance, isn't enough for most hiring managers. Instead, you should provide a concrete example of when you worked on a team to accomplish a goal. Moreover, remember that the best way to express your personality is to simply be yourself!

Adapted for pedagogical purposes from:
https://www.businessnewsdaily.com/7950-personality-traits-hired.html

AFTER READING

Complete the following summary diagram of the text with the words and phrases in the box. Two have been done for you!

~~technical knowledge~~ / a cultural fit / experience / hard / qualifications / ~~hired~~ / abilities / a strategist / soft / a decider / personality traits / a team player / have / a cautious person / an independent thinker / a multitasker



According to the text, are both types of skills equally important?

……

VOCABULARY BUILDING

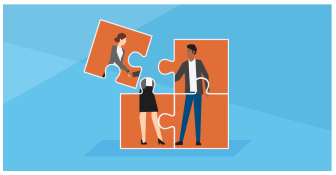
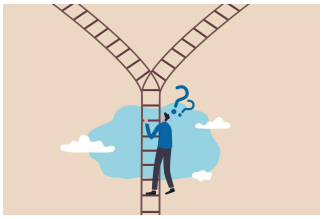
Complete the "soft skills" chart by doing the following:

a. **Have a look at the pictures and guess the personality traits.**
b. **Complete the definition of each trait with a sentence from the text.**
c. **Which of the groups of adjectives below may describe each type of personality better? Write them down in the "characteristics" column of the chart.**

~~1. productive, dynamic, efficient, and organized~~
2. resolute, decisive, and strong-minded
3. analytical, anticipatory, strategic, and results-oriented
4. prudent, careful, and sensible
5. communicative, collaborative and respectful to others
6. nonconformist, critical, proactive, and self-determined
7. flexible and adaptable

Have a look at the example!

PERSONALITY TRAIT	DEFINITION	CHARACTERISTICS
1) A multitasker	He/She can come out of his/her role and do several tasks at the same time.	He/She is productive, dynamic, efficient, and organized.
2) _____		

 3) _____		
 4) _____		
 5) _____		
 6) _____		
 7) _____		

LEXIS AND GRAMMAR STOP

QUALITIES, ABILITIES, LIKES AND DISLIKES

Have a look at the following examples. Can you work out the rules?

DESCRIBING QUALITIES

Examples:

✔ I'm *a flexible worker.*

✔ The candidate is *a dependable person.*

✔ You are *an organized employee.*

Rule: Singular Subject + be + _____ + _____ + _____.

DESCRIBING ABILITIES

Examples:

- A strategist *can identify* long-term goals.
- A multitasker *can do* several tasks at the same time.

Rule: Subject + can + _____ + rest…

Examples:

- A strategist *is good at identifying* long-term goals.
- A multitasker *is good at doing* several tasks at the same time.

Rule: Subject + be + _____ + __ + _____ + rest…

Examples:

- A strategist *finds it easy to identify* long-term goals.
- A multitasker *finds it easy to do* several tasks at the same time.

Rule: Subject + find + __ + _____ + "to" infinitive verb + rest…

DESCRIBING LIKES AND DISLIKES

Examples:

- I *love working* with other people for a common goal.
- A multitasker *enjoys doing* multiple activities at once.

- Team players *hate working* on their own.

Rule: Subject + _____ + _____ + rest…

Notice! If you want to talk about your weaknesses, it is advisable to soften them by contrasting them with a positive idea. Have a look at the following example:

- I'm a little absent-minded. However, I try to keep an organized planner.

CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 1

a) Paraphrase the following sentences by using the word(s) between parentheses. Keep the meaning of the given sentence. Have a look at the example.

Example: Janice can encourage other people to work well. (good at)
*Janice **is good at encouraging** other people to work well.*

1. My colleague Jennifer can work under strict deadlines easily. (find)
   ……
2. Both John and Sarah are good at handling multitasks. (can)
   ……
3. Sam is hard-working and reliable. (employee)
   ……
4. Sophie can work under pressure and meet deadlines. (is good)
   ……
5. Jason isn't good at dealing with people. (find)
   ……

VOCABULARY BUILDING

UNIVERSITY PROFESSIONS

a) Fill in the blanks with the name of the corresponding programme or professional. The first one has been done for you.

PROGRAMME **I am studying…**	**PROFESSIONAL** **I'll become A/AN…**
[1] Accounting	Accountant
[2] ……	Architect
[3] ……	Economy Consultant
[4] Civil/Computing/Electronic/ Industrial/Mechanical Engineering	Civil/Computing/Electronic/ Industrial/Mechanical ……
[5] …… ……	Social Worker
[6] Nutrition	……
[7] …… ……	International Business Consultant/Expert
[8] Kinesiology	……
[9] ……	Labour Relations Manager
[10] Law	……
[11] ……	Media Expert / Journalist
[12] ……	Physician
[13] B.A. in Nursing	……
[14] …… ……	Administrative Services Manager
[15] …… ……	Public Relations Manager
[16] …… ……	Political Analyst/Expert
[17] …… ……	Physical Education Teacher/Trainer
[18] …… …… ……	Protocol and Ceremonial Consultant

b) Have a look at what these professionals are saying. Complete the blanks with the right expressions from the box. Then, decide what personality trait each one has.

1. Philip Clough, public relations manager:

an open-minded manager / good at finding / love working

"I [1]…… with other people for a common goal. I'm [2]…… . When there're very different opinions on the same issue, I am [3]…… a balance. This helps me to maintain a positive work environment."

What personality trait is dominant in him? He is a [4]……

2. Benjamin Ledge, media expert:

'm not stubborn / can help / don't find it hard to challenge

"I sometimes disagree with my boss's viewpoint. However, I'm not afraid of telling her my ideas because I feel that I [5]…… to boost the company's sales. I [6]…… but if I think I have a better idea, I [7]…… authority."

What personality trait is dominant in him? He is an [8]……

3. Helen Marvel, social worker:

a sensible person / can't find / good at keeping

"In my team, there are workmates who are high-fliers and will do anything to achieve the company's goals. This characteristic may be a little negative as sometimes they [9]…… a midpoint, which can lead to serious mistakes. I'm [10]…… so I'm there to prevent them from taking too many risks. I am [11]…… a balance between risks and stability!"

What personality trait is dominant in her? She is a [12]……

AUTONOMOUS WORK 2.1: LOG INTO MIeL!

SECTION 2

GRAMMAR STOP

Let's reread this extract from the text on personality traits. Pay attention to the word in bold letters. What is it used for?

When you're applying for a job, employers want to know about your hard skills, which show that you are qualified for a position. **Also,** they want to see that you will fit in with the company culture.

CONNECTORS (PART II)

ALSO - BESIDES - WHAT'S MORE

What are the differences between sentences a and b in terms of meaning? What about punctuation and position?

a) Employers want to know about your hard skills and make sure that you will fit in with the company culture.
b) Employers want to know about your hard skills. Besides, / Also, / What's more, they want to make sure that you will fit in with the company culture.

Can you include these connectors in the table of connectors below?

The CONNECTORS table						
Addition	**Result**	**Contrast**	**Reason**	**Time**	**Condition**	**Position and punctuation**
and	so	but	AS			**(1)** __ ~ __ . or __ , ~ __ .
	THEREFORE	HOWEVER				**(2)** __ . ~ , __ . or __ ; ~ , __ .
			because	when	if	**(3)** ~ __ , __ . or __ ~ __ .

CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 2

a) In the following text, choose the right option.

Is it good to be a multitasker? Researchers say the answer is… no!

Do you feel pressure to be good at multitasking at work? According to a recent study, nearly three in four employees feel pressure to multitask during the workday. [1]**What's more/However**, people who don't consider themselves multitaskers often feel frustrated [2]**as/so** they lack this "ability".

Over the past decade, researchers have been questioning if it is a good thing to be a multitasker at work. After numerous studies, the answer is clear: Multitasking is not so good; [3]**also/however**, it is not so common. In this regard, neuropsychologist Cynthia Kubu states this: "We think we're multitasking. [4]**Besides/However**, most often we aren't really doing two things at once. Instead, we're doing individual actions in rapid succession. [5]**Therefore/Also**, strictly speaking, this is called task-switching."

b) Join these ideas using "therefore", "however" or "besides".

1. Technical skills are necessary for a job. They are not enough by themselves because soft skills are equally important.

   ……

   ……

2. Employers want employees that have the necessary technical knowledge for the job. They look for candidates with problem-solving and critical thinking skills.

   ……

   ……

3. Effective communication is essential for teamwork. It's crucial to develop strong verbal and written communication skills.

   ……

   ……

EXPRESS YOURSELF

Choose ONE of the topics below. Write a 5-sentence paragraph using at least two elements from each column below. Also, include at least ONE example of PASSIVE VOICE. Have a look at the example!

…good at…	*therefore*
I can …	*however*
…find it… to…	*but*
I'm a/an…	*besides*
I like…	*as*

1. What soft skills does a professional in your area have?
2. Soft skills are as important as hard skills.
3. Being (a strategist, a multitasker, etc.) is the most important personality trait to get hired in any job.
4. I will be a great (your profession: lawyer / social worker / etc.) because I am (your personality traits: an independent thinker / a multitasker / etc.).
5. When you are called for a job interview, you are usually asked to describe yourself. What are you like? What are your personality traits and qualities? What are your strong and weak points?

Have a look at this sample answer to question 5:

I **am an introverted person**, but I **am a good team player**. When I **am assigned** a task at work, I **like brainstorming** ideas with other team members **as** you usually get the best ideas for projects. I am always open to different opinions. **However**, I am not afraid of giving my opinion when something is wrong. **Therefore**, I **can maintain** a balance between the good and bad aspects of the group.

Now, it's your turn!

.....

.....

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.....

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AUTONOMOUS WORK 2.2: LOG INTO MIeL!

SECTION 3

BIO PILL

BEFORE READING

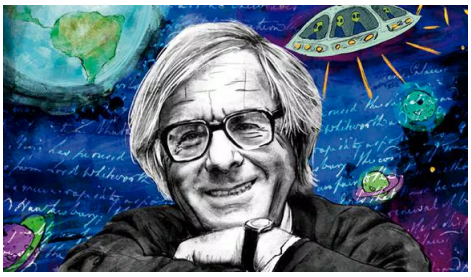
Read the title of the Bio Pill and have a look at the picture, which personality trait/s could "a visionary" have?

PRUDENT / PROACTIVE / FLEXIBLE AND ADAPTABLE / CRITICAL / SELF-DETERMINED / DEPENDENT / ANALYTICAL / SENSIBLE

WHILE READING

Did Bradbury have any of the characteristics above? Account for your choices.

THE VISIONARY



Ray Bradbury was born in 1920 and died in 2012. He was a famous American writer. He was born in Waukegan, Illinois. During the 1920s and early 1930s, his family moved back and forth between Waukegan and Tucson, Arizona. In 1934, they finally settled in Los Angeles.

Bradbury learned to read and write when he was very young, and he spent many hours in the library. When he became a teenager in Hollywood, he met many professional writers that he had admired for a long time. By the time he was 16, he had joined the Los Angeles Science Fiction Society.

In 1938, he published his first story, "Hollerbochen's Dilemma." After he had finished the story, he predicted it wasn't very good —and he was right because people criticized it. However, some years later, he published his first popular book, "The Martian Chronicles". In this book, he connected many short stories that he had written before but couldn't sell.

His most famous novel, "Fahrenheit 451", came out in 1953. Before Bradbury published this book, he had written two short stories with similar ideas: "Bright Phoenix" and "The Pedestrian." During his long career, he wrote more than 400 short stories and almost fifty books.

Bradbury often told a story about meeting a carnival magician called Mr. Electrico when he was twelve. The magician touched him with an electric sword and said, "Live forever!" Bradbury said that after he had heard those words, he decided to write every day —and he never stopped.

Adapted for pedagogical purposes from:
https://www.thoughtco.com/biography-of-ray-bradbury-4797153
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/A_Sound_of_Thunder
https://raybradbury.com/life/

AFTER READING

Are these statements true or false? When false, provide the correct version.

1. _____ For many years during Ray's childhood, the Bradburys were like rolling stones.
2. _____ Bradbury's first published short story was unexpectedly unsuccessful.
3. _____ Bradbury was inspired by the theme in his novel *Fahrenheit 451* to write the short stories "Bright Phoenix" and "The Pedestrian".
4. _____ Bradbury decided that writing was the best way to become immortal.

GRAMMAR STOP

Let's reread this extract from the Bio Pill. Look at the underlined verbs. Do you know the names of these tenses? What are they used for?

In 1934, Ray Bradbury **moved** to Hollywood. When he **became** a teenager, he **met** many professional writers that he ***had admired*** for a long time. By the time he **was** 16, he ***had joined*** the Los Angeles Science Fiction Society.

THE PAST SIMPLE REVISITED!

The Simple Past is used to express an activity or situation that began and ended in the past. There are both regular and irregular verbs. Regular verbs add –ed to the base form whereas irregular verbs form the Simple Past in a variety of ways. It is usually used with past time expressions such as "yesterday, last month/year, a few days ago" and dates like "in 1990, in 300 BCE, etc".

Example:
In 1934, Ray Bradbury **moved** to Hollywood.

PAST PERFECT

The Past Perfect is used to express an action in the past which happened before another action in the past. Therefore, it is sometimes called PAST BEFORE PAST. We use time expressions such as "before that day, a day before, by that day/then" and connectors like "because, after, before" with the Past Perfect.

Example:
In Hollywood, he **met** many professional writers that he ***had admired*** for a long time.

B	A
PAST SIMPLE	PAST PERFECT

* Event 1: Bradbury admired some professional writers for a long time. (A)
* Event 2: He met those writers. (B)

How is the Past Perfect tense formed?

- **Affirmative and negative sentences:**
  ANY SUBJECT + HAD ('D) / HAD NOT (HADN'T) + PAST PARTICIPLE …

- **Interrogative sentences:**
  [WH-] + HAD + ANY SUBJECT + PAST PARTICIPLE … ?

CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 3

Read this extract from Bradbury's biography and underline the correct verb form.

Ray Bradbury (August 22, 1920 – June 5, 2012) was a remarkable American writer. He was born in Waukegan, Illinois, the son of telephone and power lineman Leonard Spaulding Bradbury and Esther Bradbury (née Moberg), an immigrant from Sweden.

For a time during the 1920s and early 1930s, the Bradburys moved back and forth between Waukegan and Tucson, Arizona, following Leonard as he [1]**looked/had looked** for a job. Eventually, they settled in Los Angeles in 1934 as Leonard [2]**found/had found** steady work making wire for a cable company. As Bradbury [3]**had started/started** reading and writing from a young age, once he was in Hollywood as a teenager, he seized the opportunity to befriend the professional writers he [4]**had admired/admired** for so many years. Science fiction writer Bob Olsen became a particular mentor, and by age 16, Bradbury [5]**joined/had joined** the Los Angeles Science Fiction Society.

GRAMMAR STOP

Let's reread these extracts from the Bio Pill. Look at the underlined words. What is their function? Which action happened first in each case? How do you know?

> In 1938, he published his first story, "Hollerbochen's Dilemma." **<u>After</u>** he had finished the story, he predicted it wasn't very good —and he was right because people criticized it.

His most famous novel, "Fahrenheit 451", came out in 1953. **Before** Bradbury published this book, he had written two short stories with similar ideas: "Bright Phoenix" and "The Pedestrian."

CONNECTORS (PART III)

AFTER / BEFORE

The connectors "after" and "before" help to indicate the order of two past events. The Past Perfect tense is used for the action that happened first. Compare these examples:

- Bradbury **had encountered** the carnival magician Mr. Electrico **before** he started writing every day.
- Bradbury started writing every day **after** he **had encountered** the carnival magician Mr. Electrico.

In both examples, the sequence of events is indicated by the connectors and the use of the Past Perfect tense for the action that happened first.

Can you include them in the table of connectors below?

The CONNECTORS table						
Addition	**Result**	**Contrast**	**Reason**	**Time**	**Condition**	**Position and punctuation**
and	so	but	AS			**(1)** __ ~ __ . or __ , ~ __ .
ALSO BESIDES WHAT'S MORE	THEREFORE	HOWEVER				**(2)** __ . ~ , __ . or __ ; ~ , __ .
			because	when	if	**(3)** ~ __ , __ . or __ ~ __ .

CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 4

a) Complete the sentences using "after" or "before".

1. …… the Bradburys settled in Los Angeles in 1934, they had moved like rolling stones.
2. Bradbury met some professional writers …… he had settled in Los Angeles.
3. Bradbury had admired several professional writers for a long time …… he became a member of the Los Angeles Science Fiction Society.
4. …… Mr. Electrico had commanded Bradbury to live forever, the little kid decided to become a writer.

b) Join these sentences using "after" and "before". One of the verbs must be expressed in the Past Perfect tense.

1. The Bradburys moved back and forth between Waukegan and Tucson. They settled in Los Angeles in 1934.

   1.a)……
   ……

   1.b)……
   ……

2. Bradbury settled in Hollywood. He met several professional writers.

   2.a)……
   ……

   2.b)……
   ……

QUESTION BLOCK

a) First, order out the following questions about Bradbury's biography. Then, match the questions with the corresponding answers.

1. Bardbury's career / had / Mr. Electrico / before he became / strongly influenced / a famous writer / ?

   ……

2. what / Mr Electrico / had / done / to become a writer / before Bradbury decided / ?

   ……

3. had / the Bradburys / before / had / in Los Angeles in 1934 / they / settled / a stable life / ?

   ……

4. Bradbury himself / what / had / predicted / "Hollerbochen's Dilemma" / was published / before / ?

   ……

a. No, they had moved back and forth between Waukegan and Tucson.
b. He had commanded Bradbury to live forever.
c. The failure of the story.
d. Yes, he had!

b) Now, pay attention to the structure of the questions above and complete the rule.

PAST PERFECT QUESTIONS

[INTERROGATIVE WORD]		ANY SUBJECT		…?

CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 5

Make factual questions on these extracts using interrogative words. Underline the answers in each text.

1. In the years leading up to the Great Depression, Bradbury's family struggled financially, moving back and forth between Tucson, Arizona and Waukegan as his father found various employment opportunities. When Bradbury was 14, his family

settled in Los Angeles, California as his father had found steady work making wire for a cable company.

a. Who……?
b. Why……?
c. ……?

2. "Employers want to know about your hard skills, which show that you are qualified for a position. Also, they want to see that you will fit in with the company culture. The only way to assess this is to get a sense of your personality," said Susan Peppercorn, CEO of Positive Workplace Partners. "Knowing that someone has the experience and skills to be successful in a job is very important, but when two candidates have similar capabilities, often the soft skills are the reason why one person gets the job and the other doesn't."

d. What……?
e. Who……?
f. ……?

AUTONOMOUS WORK 2.3: LOG INTO MIeL!

TIME FOR FICTION II:
"A SOUND OF THUNDER" BY RAY BRADBURY - PART II

BEFORE READING

a) Read the summary of the first part, choose the correct connector and complete the blanks with the right verb form.

In "A Sound of Thunder", which [1]_____ **(write)** by Ray Bradbury, *Time Safari* brings customers back in time to hunt now-extinct animals for thousands of dollars. The story [2]_____ **(open)** with one of them, who [3]_____ **(call)** Eckles.

Eckels stood at the front desk of the time travel agency and [4]_____ **(wait)** to be taken back in time [5]***so/but*** he could meet a Tyrannosaurus Rex. [6]***When/So*** he gave his check for $10,000, he [7]_____ **(ask)** if his survival during the journey [8]_____ **(guarantee)**. The official beyond the desk coldly answered

that they [9]_____ **(can/promise)** nothing except the dinosaur. [10]***Besides/However,*** Eckles must obey directions strictly [11]***because/so*** they couldn't make any change in the Past. [12]***However/Therefore,*** he must follow the instructions from Travis, their safari leader.

[13]***Before/After*** Eckels had discovered the Time Machine, he [14]_____ **(become)** excited and explained how glad he [15]_____ **(feel)** for the new president Keith. [16]***What's more/However,*** Eckles [17]_____ **(reflect)** upon how dangerous it would be for his tyrannical and dictatorial opponent Deutscher to have such a powerful device. [18]***After/Before*** the man behind the desk agreed, he continued talking about the journey and scared him with the evidence of six safari leaders and twelve hunters who [19]_____ **(die)** the year before. [20]***However/Therefore***, Eckles accepted the challenge.

b) What do you think will happen to Eckles next?

WHILE READING

Read Part 2 and check if your predictions were right or wrong.

PART II

Mr. Eckles and Mr. Travis moved silently across the room, taking their guns with them and toward the Machine, the silver metal, and the roaring light.

First a day and then a night, and then a day and a night; then it was day-night-day-night. A week, a month, a year, ten years! A.D. 2055. A.D. 2019. 1999. 1957. Gone! The Machine roared.

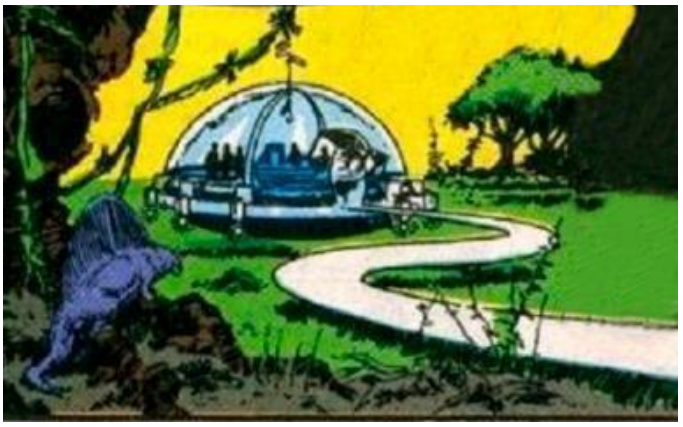
They put on their oxygen helmets and tested the radios. They were five: Eckles, Travis - the Safari Leader -, Lesperance - his assistant -, Billings and Kramer - two other hunters. They sat looking at each other when the years flew by around them.

"If you hit them right, these guns can kill a dinosaur with one shot," Travis said on the helmet radio. "Some dinosaurs have two brains: one in their heads and another one far down the backbone. Therefore, we must stay away from those as that's too dangerous. If you put your first two shots into the eyes,

they will blind the animal and go back into the brain."

Suddenly, the Machine screamed. Time was a film run backward. Suns went quickly by and ten million moons went by after them. The Machine slowed and stopped.

The fog that had been around it blew away. They were three hunters and two safari guides with their blue metal guns across their knees in a very old time. Outside, there was the jungle of sixty million two thousand and fifty-five years before President Keith. Besides, Alexander, Julius Caesar, Napoleon or Hitler didn't exist because the first human hadn't been born yet.



The hunters were indicated a path that went off into the distance. It was made of a special metal that floated above the earth to keep them from touching the world of the past. "Stay on the path and don't leave it. If you fall off, it will cost you money. The government doesn't like us here so we have to pay a lot for certain people to travel. What's more, we don't want to change the Future as we don't have a place in the Past. We could kill an important animal, a small bird, an insect or a flower which could have an effect too small to be seen now. However, it could add up bit by bit over sixty million years into a major change. Therefore, if you destroy any creature, the caveman, a future nation and generations will be extinguished."

Moreover, Eckles, Billings and Kramer were told which animals to shoot. "They're marked with red paint," Travis said. "Before we started this journey,

we had sent Lesperance back with the Machine. He had already come to this time and followed certain animals. "

"I always study them through their whole lives, noting which of them lives longest and how many times they have young," the assistant explained. "When I find one that's going to die by accident, I note the exact hour, minute, and second, and I shoot a paint bomb that leaves a red mark on their side. Then, I plan our journey into the Past so that we meet the Monster not more than two minutes before its natural death. This way, we kill only animals with no future. Can you see how careful we are?"

"What about meeting ourselves in the past? Was our safari successful?" Eckles asked excitedly.

Travis and Lesperance looked at each other.

"That would be a paradox," said Lesperance. "Time doesn't permit it. When such things seem to happen, Time moves out of the way. Did you feel the Machine jump just before stopping? That was us passing ourselves on the way back to the Future. There's no way of telling if this Safari was a success or if we got our Monster because we saw nothing."

"Enough," Travis said sharply. "Everyone on his feet!"

They were ready to leave the Machine.

VOCABULARY BUILDING

Read the extract again and look for the words and expressions that match the following definitions:

1. ……*hit*……(v.): shoot.
2. ……(n): spinal column.
3. ……(v): having less than $^{1}/_{10}$ of normal vision; not able to see.

4. ……(n): the organ inside the head that controls thought, memory, feelings, and activity.
5. ……(n): a narrow walk or way, route, course, or track along between one place and another.
6. ……(v): rested or moved in a liquid or the air.
7. ……(v): to drop unintentionally to the ground from a high object, especially after losing one's balance.
8. ……(v): the act of travelling from one place to another, especially in a vehicle.
9. ……(n): a situation or statement that seems impossible or is difficult to understand because it contains two opposite facts or characteristics.
10. ……(n): getting the results wanted or hoped for.
11. ……(idiom): in a standing position.

AFTER READING

a) Are these statements True or False? When false, provide the correct version; when true, expand on them with information from the story.

1. Only Eckles and Travis got into the Machine. __

   ……

2. Dinosaurs could be killed with one single shot. __

   ……

3. The characters travelled to a distant place. __

   ……

4. Eckles, Billings and Kramer could leave the path whenever they wanted. __

   ……

b) Write questions on the provided answers using the verbs between brackets.

1. Who……? (WALK)

   Eckles and Travis.

2. How……? (HELP)

   He assisted him.

3. Where……? (HAVE)

   Far down the backbone.

4. Why……? (APPROACH)

   As it was really dangerous.

c) Answer the following questions reflecting upon events from the story.

1. Why did the five men wear oxygen helmets and use radios?

   ……

   ……

2. Were they interested in preserving the environment? How do you know?

   ……

   ……

3. Why are Alexander, Julius Caesar, Napoleon and Hitler (and not any other historical figures) mentioned after Keith in the story?

   ……

   ……

4. What could happen during the trip in the Time Machine?

   ……

   ……

EXPRESS YOURSELF

Useful expressions: Illustrating your point

In conversation we often want to illustrate what we are saying with an example. If we tell someone that **Eckels was "anxious"**, we can't leave it there. These phrases will help you to introduce extra information.

For example, …	**For one thing, …**
For instance, …	**To give you an idea, …**
Take the way (he) …	**Look at the way …**
Take for example …	**By way of illustration … (*formal*)**

a) Which other personality traits, abilities, qualities, likes and dislikes did Eckels have? Support your choices with evidence from the story. Then, share your thoughts with your mates and tutor in class.

Eckels was anxious. ***To give you an idea,*** ……

……

……

……

……

b) Now, choose one of the other characters and describe him in terms of personality traits, abilities, qualities, likes and dislikes. Illustrate your point and be ready to share it with the rest of the class.

……

……

……

……

ACADEMIC LITERACY II

Abstracts: Background and Aim

a) Read the abstract and choose the correct answer for each question below.

An Examination of Officer Job Satisfaction and Workgroup Cultural Fit

Jason R Ingram, Alexis R Rockwell, Chris Guerra, Eugene A Paoline III

Policing: A Journal of Policy and Practice, Volume 15, Issue 3, September 2021, Pages 1713–1728, https://doi.org/10.1093/police/paab023

Published: 07 June 2021

Abstract

Research has found that officer job satisfaction is correlated with aspects of their work environment. Police culture serves as a coping mechanism for work environment stressors. Despite the connections, research has yet to investigate the impact of a broad range of cultural norms as well as the influence of cultural fit and strength on job satisfaction. The current study examines how officers' alignments with traditional police culture norms, relative to their workgroup peers (i.e. cultural fit), relate to job satisfaction. Results indicated that officers who adhered to traditional norms, in general, were more satisfied; however, officers who subscribed substantially less to traditional cultural norms relative to their workgroup peers (i.e. con-culture misfits) were significantly less satisfied. Being a con-culture misfit was associated with perceptions of danger and role clarity. Collectively, the findings provide practical insights for departments concerned with their officers satisfaction by addressing cultural features of their work environments.

Source: https://doi.org/10.1093/police/paab023

1. What does research show about job satisfaction and work environment?
   a. Police job satisfaction is not correlated with aspects of the work environment.
   b. Police job satisfaction is correlated with aspects of the work environment.
   c. Police job satisfaction may be correlated with aspects of the work environment.

2. What is a coping mechanism for work environment stressors?
   a. A coping mechanism is being a con-culture misfit.
   b. A coping mechanism is police culture.
   c. There is not a coping mechanism for work environment stressors.

b) Now, reread the abstract and find the two expressions that introduce the BACKGROUND and the AIM of the study. Write them in the chart below.

Background	**Aim**

c) The following expressions can also be used to introduce the BACKGROUND and the AIM of a study. Can you sort them out in the chart above?

1. The aim of this paper is to examine…
2. Current literature on (job satisfaction) demonstrates that…
3. Previous studies indicate that…
4. The objective of this study is to explore…
5. This study seeks to examine…
6. Previous research shows that…

Let's continue practising!

d) Put the following phrases in order and use them to complete the blanks in the abstract below.

1. to / this / examine / seeks / study …

   ……

2. shows / research / that / previous …

   ……

Traits and Personal Values: A Meta-Analysis

Laura Parks-Leduc, Gilad Feldman, and Anat Bardi

[1]…… personality traits and personal values are important psychological characteristics, serving as important predictors of many outcomes. However, they are frequently studied separately, leaving the field with a limited understanding of their relationships. [2]…… existing perspectives regarding the nature of the relationships between traits and values and provide a conceptual underpinning for understanding the strength of these relationships. Using 60 studies, we present a meta-analysis of the relationships between the Five-Factor Model (FFM) of personality traits and the Schwartz values, and demonstrate consistent and theoretically meaningful relationships. However, these relationships were not generally large, demonstrating that traits and values are distinct constructs. We find support for our premise that more cognitively based traits are more strongly related to values and more emotionally based traits are less strongly related to values. Findings also suggest that controlling for personal scale-use tendencies in values is advisable.

Keywords
personality traits, personal values, meta-analysis

Adapted for pedagogical purposes from:
https://www.researchgate.net/publication/262224477_Personality_Traits_and_Personal_Values_A_Meta-Analysis

e) Choose the correct answer for each question.

1. What is the problem with current studies on personality traits and personal values?
   a. They always study these two psychological characteristics jointly.
   b. They usually study these two psychological characteristics separately.
   c. They hardly ever study these two psychological characteristics separately.

2. How is the meta-analysis carried out?
   a. By using the Five-Factor Model (FFM) of personality traits.
   b. By using the Schwartz values.
   c. By using the Five-Factor Model (FFM) of personality traits and the Schwartz values.